



1 Bafana Bafana

The national football team, the word 'bafana' meaning the boys in the Nguni language



2 The Calabash

The 94,700-seater stadium also known as Soccer City, is designed in the shape of a traditional African pot, the calabash

3 Vuvuzela:

South Africa's unique stadium horn, a metre-long plastic trumpet whose legendary noise set off a debate over allowing it into 2010 World Cup games. The argument for the vuvuzela drowned out the debate.



4 Makarapa:

The South African fan's headgear of choice, a colourfully decorated miner's helmet/ hard hat worn with outsized glasses



5 Diski dance:

The official South African line dance for the World Cup, its moves borrowed from the game and the word 'diski' coming from township slang for football



IN A LANDMARK EVENT, THE AFRIKANER-DOMINATED BULLS RUGBY TEAM CELEBRATED A SUPER-14S WIN IN SOWETO STADIUM

R640 million (Rs 90 crore) will be spent to deploy 41,000 specially trained police officials for the 2010 World Cup.

second round in 2002, 'Bafana Bafana' have not kicked on. Instead they are a shadow of the side that was continental champions in 1996. The development of young talent has been poor, with coaches highlighting this as the glaring weakness in South African football.

An entire nation is hoping to be the crucial 12th man for the team with vociferous support from the stands. The 'vuvuzela', a trumpet of sorts that is part and parcel of the local scene, was met with disdain by players who participated in last year's Confederations Cup. Spain and Italy called for the offending instrument to be banned, but the FIFA has said it adds to the atmosphere, and coach Parreira has called on all the 'vuvuzelas' to be on full blast to aid his side. No South African will care how the team makes it to the last 16, so long as they get there. The motto it seems is, 'By any means necessary'.

To our visitors I have to say that, despite the usual reports predicting massacres on every street, what you are more likely to find is a country in party mode for a month.

Yet, mindful of the country's noto-

rious reputation for crime, South Africa has invested heavily in getting over 10,000 extra police officers into gear. These extra numbers will allow key areas including fan parks, high volume roads and public areas to be heavily guarded. Crime hot spots have also been given extra attention, with CCTV cameras adorning most city centres. The general message now being sent out by authorities is that if the tourists don't behave reckless, they should enjoy themselves.

Every major city is transformed into a cacophony of colour for the occasion. The beaches of Durban will provide variety to the parties of Cape Town and the malls of Johannesburg, along with the country's vast range of attractions will ensure that the entertainment doesn't just end on the field.

South Africa has put on its best frock and, after much work, is ready to put out its best foot and welcome the world with open arms.

It is time. *Wozani* (Come on in.)

The author is sports writer for The Witness, Pietermaritzburg, the oldest daily newspaper in South Africa